

College Syllabus

Course Name	American Government
Course Number	C08
Prerequisites	None
Credits	3.0 college credit hours
Delivery Method	Distance learning
Course Materials	Digital textbook: <i>We the People: An Introduction to American Government</i>
Methods of Instruction	Reading assignments, practices, and videos
Methods of Assessment	Quizzes and graded projects
Course Description	In this course, you'll explore how the founders formed the government, how it's structured, and how it operates. You'll consider how civil liberties and civil rights are affected by federalism. You'll examine the three branches of government that comprise the system of checks and balances—legislative, executive, and judicial. You'll also learn about the political system of parties and interest groups and how they influence public opinion and participate in the government. You'll find that although the Constitution, in principle, grants certain rights and liberties to the people, many groups still need to be allowed those rights in practice and have had to fight for them. The nature of the US government means that the people have a voice and that the Constitution is a living document because it can be adapted and amended to change with the times.

Course Objectives

General Objectives	Assessments
Demonstrate an understanding of the liberal arts, natural sciences, and social sciences	Quizzes
Demonstrate effective written and interpersonal communication skills	Graded projects
Core Objectives	Assessments
Analyze how political thinking in America and the historical basis for such thought contributed to the process required to form the foundations of the government	Lesson 1 quiz
Summarize the debate, factors, principles, and events that led to the creation of the US Constitution	Lesson 2 quiz
Explain how our civil rights and civil liberties are affected by federalism	Lesson 3 quiz
Describe the roles and responsibilities of the executive branch of government and how it functions through the federal bureaucracy	Lesson 4 graded project

Describe the roles and responsibilities of the legislative branch of government	Lesson 5 quiz
Describe the roles and responsibilities of the judicial branch of government	Lesson 6 quiz
Explain how political parties and interest groups influence governmental policy and their role in campaigns and elections	Lesson 7 graded project
Identify the ways that public opinion and public participation influence governmental policy	Lesson 8 quiz

Credit Hour Calculation

Lesson	Knowledge Acquisition	Knowledge Application
Lesson 1: The Origins of the American Government	9 hours 00 minutes	5 hours 00 minutes
Lesson 2: The Constitution	10 hours 00 minutes	5 hours 00 minutes
Lesson 3: Federalism and Civil Liberties	14 hours 00 minutes	6 hours 00 minutes
Lesson 4: The Presidency and the Federal Bureaucracy	13 hours 00 minutes	8 hours 00 minutes
Lesson 5: The Legislature	11 hours 00 minutes	5 hours 00 minutes
Lesson 6: The Judicial Branch	11 hours 00 minutes	5 hours 00 minutes
Lesson 7: Political Parties and Interest Groups	13 hours 00 minutes	8 hours 00 minutes
Lesson 8: Public Opinion and Public Participation	12 hours 00 minutes	6 hours 00 minutes
Total	93 hours 00 minutes	48 hours 00 minutes

Grading Criteria

Grades are calculated on the following scale:

Grade (Percent)	Letter Equivalent	Rating	QPA
90–100	A	Excellent	4.0
80–89	B	Good	3.0
70–79	C	Average	2.0
Below 70	F	Failing	0.0

An overall lesson average of 70% or above is required to pass your course. Refer to the Academic Policies section of the [College Catalog](#) for specific information on grades.

Items contributing to your grade:

Graded Item	Percentage
Lesson 1: The Origins of the American Government	10%
Lesson 2: The Constitution	10%
Lesson 3: Federalism and Civil Liberties	10%
Lesson 4: The Presidency and the Federal Bureaucracy	20%
Lesson 5: The Legislature	10%
Lesson 6: The Judicial Branch	10%
Lesson 7: Political Parties and Interest Groups	20%
Lesson 8: Public Opinion and Public Participation	10%

Academic Integrity

Refer to your Student Catalog regarding academic integrity. Since you're learning in an online setting, it's important to practice online etiquette.

Online Library

Students in College will have access to an online library for use during their studies with the school. Students can use this library to do the required research in the courses they complete or can use it for general reference and links to valuable resources. The library contains helpful research assistance, articles, databases, books, web links, and email access to a librarian. Students can access the library from their homepage. A librarian is available to answer questions on general research-related topics via email and assist students in research activities during their studies with Penn Foster College.